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Dadasaheb Phalke

Father of Indian Cinema

Work Span: 1912-1944

Prominent Films: Raja Harishchandra, Mohini Bhasmasur, Satyavan Savitri, Lanka Dahan, Shri Krishna Janma, Kaliya Mardan, Setubandhan, Gangavataran.



Dadasaheb Phalke (b.1870-d.1944) was born as Dhundiraj Govind Phalke. Though he was from a modest Marathi-speaking Chitpavan Brahmin family of scholars & priests, Dadasaheb first worked as a Sanskrit professor and by 1890, he got art-related training in photography. As early as 1895, he decided to become a professional photographer. This was not an easy job at the time when people thought that a camera sucks out energy from a person and kills him!

Dadasaheb's journey to become the first Indian film Producer and Director (rather all-in-one) was nothing, if not arduous. From 1893 to 1911, Dadasaheb dabbled in several activities involving photography

On his return to India in 1912, Dadasaheb formed 'Phalke Films Company'. After hectic efforts – including importing & setting up the film-making equipment, making dark room and teaching his family to perforate the film – his first 1-minute film named Ankurachi Wadh (Growth of a Sprout) was ready. This involved shooting just one frame a day of a pea plant for over a month, effectively capturing the growth of the plant. This film was shown to financiers. It was a very short film but it did yield some finance.

From here on, Dadasaheb undertook making of the film Raja Harishchandra. No women were available that time to play female leads, so males played female roles. Dadasaheb himself handled a variety of responsibilities like Production, Direction, Script, Editing and Processing. The film, comprising 4 reels, took about six months for its completion. Premiered at Olympia theatre in 1913, it was a success and recognized as the first full-length Indian feature film.

The next films in the line, both successful, were Mohini Bhasmasur and Satyavan Savitri. The former featured Durgabai Kamat and Kamlabai Gokhale, the first women to act in Indian Cinema. Dadasaheb visited

Abhi Bhattarcharya Actor Work Span: 1952-1993 Prominent Films: Yatrik (Debut), Biraj Bahu, Jagriti, Sailaab, Anuradha, Dosti, Mahabharat, Naunihaal, Aradhana, Amar Prem, Samadhi, Dost, Imtihan, Dhuan.	
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Abhi Bhattacharya (b.1921-d.1993) was one of the most adaptable actors of the Golden Era. Tall, handsome and possessing a soft persona, Bhattacharya played lead roles opposite top heroines in the 50s and character roles thereafter. In Jagriti (1954), he portrayed a compassionate teacher and appeared in the iconic patriotic song *Aao bachchon tumhen dikhaen*. Over a career spanning four decades, he featured in more than 150 films.

Acha	
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Ahmed Wasi Lyricist Work Span: 1972-2013 Prominent Films: Taxi Driver, Pran Jaye Par Vachan Na Jaye, Kanoon Aur Mujrim, Vakil-e-Azam, Yatra.	
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Ahmed Wasi (b.1942) is a poet, ghazal writer and radio announcer. He was born in Uttar Pradesh and joined the Vividh Bharati service of All India Radio as a radio announcer for Hello Farmaish in 1963. He gained recognition for the song *Aa ke dard jawan hai*, composed by OP Nayyar for the film Pran Jaye Par Vachan Na Jaye. OP Nayyar later collaborated with him again, composing music for his lyrics in Taxi Driver and Heera Moti.

Abbas Khan	
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Achala Sachdev

Actor

Work Span: 1938-2012

Prominent Films: Fashionable Wife (debut), Adalat, Dil Ek Mandir, Shagoon, Sangam, Haqeeqat, Waqt, Mere Sanam, Prem Pujari, Anamika, Parinay, Julie.



Achala Sachdev (b.1920-d.2012) was a veteran film actress. She began her acting career early, performing on Lahore radio. She made her initial foray into films in the late 30s. She quickly established herself as a versatile artist and became a beloved figure in Indian cinema. She was introduced to Clifford Peters on a film set who would later be her second husband. Peters had a factory Morris Electronics in Pune. Achala then became a resident of Pune.

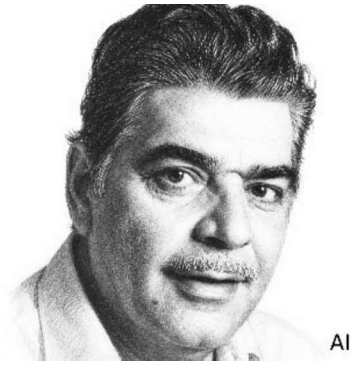
Achala's Bollywood career spanned over six decades, truly remarkable. A mother archetype, her legacy lay in defining the supportive, caring and long-suffering mother or grandmother roles in Hindi cinema.

Ajit

Actor

Work Span: 1946-1995

Prominent Films: Beqasoor, Saiyan, Samrat, Nastik, Halaku, Naya Daur, Shikari, Suraj, Prince, Zanjeer, Yaadon Ki Baaraat, Jugnu, Dharma, Kalicharan.



Ajit (b.1922-d.1998), a leading hero of the 50s and sophisticated villain of the 70s, was born as Hamid Ali Khan in Hyderabad. Aspiring to be an actor, he sold his books to buy a train ticket and left home in the early 40s. After some struggle, Ajit's break came by a lead role in Beqasoor (1950), opposite Madhubala! Tall, well-built and with magnetic voice, Ajit soon became a lead actor. Kavi Pradeep's song *Kitna badal gaya insaan* (Nastik) was filmed on him.

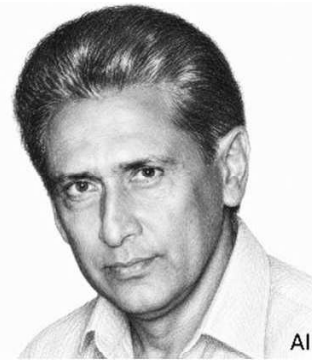
In the 50s & 60s, Ajit worked as lead actor with all top heroines and sang some good songs onscreen like *Bhula nahi dena* (Bara-Dari) and *Ye dach hai mere imanon ka* (Naya Daur). But it was Suraj (1966) which

C Arjun

Music Director

Work Span: 1958-1990

Prominent Films: Road No.303 (Debut), Punar Milan, Main Aur Mera Bhai, Susheela, Jai Santoshi Maa, Mangu Dada, Raksha Bandhan, Nawab Sahib.



Arjun Parmanand Chandnani or C Arjun (b.1933-d.1992) came with his family to Vadodara after Partition. His father was also a musician. Arjun joined composer Bulo C Rani as assistant in mid-50s. His first film was a low budget film Road No. 303 (1960) with some good songs by Rafi and Asha. His next film Susheela boasted of a rare Rafi-Talat duet *Gham ki andheri raat mein*. Unfortunately, the film was released only in 1977 as Subah Zaroor Aayegi.

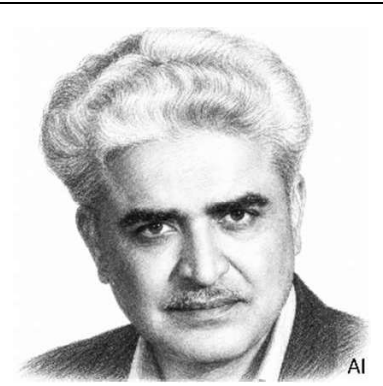
C Arjun composed mostly for B-Grade films throughout his career in spite of some lovely songs. *Pas baitho tabiyat behal jayegi* (Punar Milan) is lovely ghazal-style song. Rafi was so much impressed with the tune that

C Ramchandra

Music Director, Singer

Work Span: 1942-1979

Prominent Films: Patanga, Samadhi, Shehnai, Albela, Anarkali, Sargam, Subah Ka Tara, Azaad, Parchhain, Devta, Amar Deep, Paigham, Navrang, Stree.



Ramchandra Chitalkar or C Ramchandra (b.1918-d.1982), or ‘Anna’ (big brother) as he was affectionately called, was a music composer who blended Western Music with Indian Classical effortlessly. When his debut as an actor failed miserably in Naganand, he turned to music arrangements on the advice of Sohrab Modi. Master Bhagwan and poet Pradeep were his close friends. He was given break as independent music composer in Bhagwan’s Sukhi Jeevan (1942).

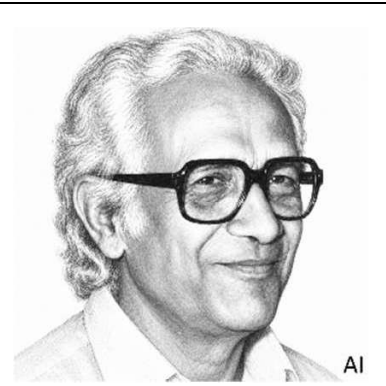
Anna is remembered for his remarkable range – from breezy, light-hearted songs like *Mere piya gaye Rangoon* (Patanga) to the classical *Radha na bole* (Azaad) and the rare, trendsetting *Iss minn diha* (Aasha). He

Chetan Anand

Writer, Director

Work Span: 1946-1986

Prominent Films: Neecha Nagar (Debut), Aandhiyan, Funtoosh, Kinare Kinare, Haqeeqat, Aakhri Khat, Heer Raanjha, Hanste Zakhm, Jaaneman, Kudrat.



Chetan Anand (b.1921-d.1997) was one of the pioneering filmmakers who helped shape the Golden Era of Indian cinema with his talent and passion for meaningful storytelling. Before venturing into films in the early 40s, he wanted to join Civil Services. He appeared for the examinations but failed to qualify for ICS cadre in London. He also worked as a teacher, a BBC radio professional and an educator at The Doon School.

Chetan made his directorial debut with Neecha Nagar (1946), which won the Grand Prix at the inaugural Cannes Film Festival. In 1949, Chetan Anand co-founded Navketan Films with his brother Dev

Crossword Puzzle

How well do you remember the Golden Era? Enough to solve this Crossword Puzzle without Googling? Well, why not try? No problem if you can't get them all. The solution is provided ... somewhere in this book!

Warning: Solving this may cause sudden humming of vintage songs and an urge to rewatch black-and-white classics!

Lights. Camera. Crossword! Your cue to begin.

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Filmfare Awards

- The 1st Filmfare Awards function, held on March 21, 1954, was originally known as the 'Clare Awards', named after Clare Mendonça, a renowned film critic for The Times of India.
- Bimal Roy, Dilip Kumar, Meena Kumari and Naushad, were the first Filmfare Award winners.
- The famous 'Black Lady' trophy was designed by art director NG Pansare, inspired by the style of the Academy Awards.
- Shankar-Jaikishan (9), Dilip Kumar (8), Kishore Kumar (8), Nutan (7) and Asha Bhosle (7) have won multiple awards during the Golden Era.
- Bimal Roy won the Best Director Award 7 times in the first 11 years (1954-1964).
- Lata Mangeshkar and Asha Bhosle voluntarily withdrew from Best

National Film Awards

- The National Film Awards are the most prestigious film honors in India. They were established in 1954 to promote artistic and technical excellence in Indian cinema across all languages and are administered under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting.
- The first Best Feature Film Award went to the Marathi film, *Shyamchi Aai*, produced and directed by *Āchārya* PK Atre, a prominent Marathi writer, poet, educationist and orator.
- Legendary director Satyajit Ray received 32 National Film Awards across different categories – a unique record.
- Lagaan (2001) holds the record for most awards (8) for a single film.
- Shabana Azmi won Best Actress Award five times, the highest in Indian cinema – for Godmother, Ankur, Arth, Khandhar and Paar.

Some Interesting Trivia

- Raja Harishchandra (1913) was the first film made in India, while Alam Ara (1931) was the first talkie film made.
- Inder Sabha (1932) holds the world record of having 69 songs!
- Sairandhri (1933) was the first Indian color film (Processed in Germany). Kisan Kanya (1937) was the first *desi* color film.
- Producer PL Santoshi of Nirala (1950) announced in newspapers that if the viewers didn't like the film, money would be returned (applicable in first week only)! Incidentally, the movie was a hit.
- K Asif's Love and God (1986) was in the making for 23 years!
- Although husband and wife in real life, Sunil Dutt-Nargis and Rajesh Khanna-Dimple were never seen as romantic pair onscreen.
- Saraswati Devi, born Khorshed Minocher-Homji, was the first female music composer. She gave music for Achhut Kanya (1936).
- Parul Ghosh sang the first-ever playback song and it was recorded for Dhoop Chhaon (1935). She was Anil Biswas' sister and was married to flautist Pannalal Ghosh.
- Aankhen, Dushman and Dillagi are some of the titles which are

Binaca Geetmala

- Binaca Geetmala began on 3 December 1952 on Radio Ceylon. It was presented by the legendary announcer Ameen Sayani, whose warm voice and unique style made the program immensely popular across India. The show was sponsored by the toothpaste brand Binaca, from which it derived its name.
- Amin Sayani's famous opening line, "*Bebnon aur Bhaaiyon ...*" has become iconic in Indian broadcasting.
- During the 50s, the government broadcaster All India Radio discouraged film songs on its channels. As a result, millions of listeners tuned to Radio Ceylon every week to hear the latest Hindi film songs.
- The program was a weekly countdown of the most popular Hindi film songs based on record sales, popularity among listeners, requests received by the radio station and success of the films.
- One of the highlights of the program was the year-end countdown, which listed the most popular songs of the year.
- The first top song of the year (1953) was *Ye zindagi usiki hai* (Anarkali) by Lata. She was the singer of the top song 16 times from

Relations among Celebrities

Important note: This is cursory overview, neither exhaustive nor up-to-date

M: Mother, F: Father, W: Wife, H: Husband, D: Daughter, S: Son, Sis: Sister, B: Brother.

Example: Ashok Kumar's Daughter → Bharati Jaffrey. Bharati Jaffrey's Daughter → Anuradha Patel. Anuradha Patel's Husband → Kanwaljeet. Ashok Kumar's Daughter → Rupa Ganguly. Rupa Ganguly's Husband → Deven Verma.

Agha	S: Jalal Agha		
Amitabh Bachchan	F: Harivansh Rai Bachchan		
	W: Jaya Bhaduri		
	S: Abhishek Bachchan		W: Aishwarya Rai
Amrish Puri	B: Chaman Puri		
	B: Madan Puri		
	Cousin: KL Saigal		
Anil Biswas	W: Ashalata (Mehrunnisa)		S: Utpal Biswas
	W: Meena Kapoor		
	Sis: Parul Ghosh	H: Pannalal Ghosh	